

## Apply for a Science Corps Fellowship - Entry #372

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| <b>Name</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Priyanikha Jayakumar                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Email</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <a href="mailto:priyanikha29@gmail.com">priyanikha29@gmail.com</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Gender</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Female                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>City, state, and country of residence</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Zurich, Switzerland                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Nationality</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Malaysian                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>When did or will you finish your PhD?</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| April/May 2022                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>University Education</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Doctoral (Ph.D.) candidate   Evolutionary Microbiology   University of Zurich, Switzerland   April/May 2022<br>Master's in Research (MRes)   Biomedical Research   Imperial College London, UK   September 2017<br>Bachelor's in Science (BSc, Honours)   Microbiology   Imperial College London, UK   September 2016                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps fellow?</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Education is a life changer in my opinion. I want to be that person who tells a child that he/she can be better than what everyone else thinks.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| I want to let kids dream and dream big. I want to show them that learning doesn't have to be boring and should be limitless. I want to share with them how to use the best of their talents constructively, not just to pass an exam. It matters to me that my presence will leave a lasting impact on how the children I work with view education and continue to pass that on to their peers or even their children someday.                                                                                    |
| I greatly value the emphasis of starting young and active learning at school to gain diverse exposure to what our curriculum and future career options could offer. This leads back to my own career path. With limited scientific capacity in my early days in a town in Malaysia, I slowly gained interest in Biology thanks to my Science teacher who aspired me to be where I am today. I was inspired and I want to keep inspiring our future generation so they too can land on an opportunity like myself. |

**In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship.**

As a co-organiser of a university research module, I guided students through active discussions on current gaps in biology, developing research hypotheses, and finding solutions. I was also responsible to constantly improvise the curriculum of our course, including the switch to remote learning within one month after lockdown. This journey has taught me how to be a great and inspiring teacher. My contribution as a fellow would come from a great emphasis on active learning by letting students to be critical in planning their own experiments, getting them to be analytical with their research output and guiding them to be creative in visualizing and communicating their findings.

I am also mentoring two junior PhD students on career planning. Here, I put a great emphasis on networking and getting involved in non-academic activities aiming at diversifying one's future career options. This relates back to my experience when I was overwhelmed with the great options out there but had limited guidance to grasp what would suit my strengths and expertise. I see myself contributing through the strong believe that one should continuously be curious and explore, and there's never an age limit to build or change one's career path.

**Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.**

Doing science in industry

In science education

In science outreach

**Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (two year) and long-term (ten year) future.**

I am passionate about developing novel tools to address questions that have an impact on improving global health, with a focus in underdeveloped communities. I would like to pursue a career that make use of modern technology and machine learning tools to revolutionize global healthcare with a strong drive in improving the lives of children and mothers. This opportunity would provide me avenue for critical thinking to solve real global health problems and most importantly, I would get to leave an impactful and significant contribution in the lives of people in need.

In the long future, I am aiming to build a platform for high-school students in Malaysia, especially in underserved communities, that aims to provide guidance and support on career options and the process to secure fundings and scholarships. Often, students do not get enough support to make the choices and leaps, therefore, they could not relish their true potentials. I believe that with a joint contribution of my international colleagues and friends from different backgrounds and expertise, as well as the experience that I would gain as a Science Corps fellow, we could make small changes in the lives of these students that will go a long way.

**CV/Resume**

 [PriyanikhaJayakumar CV.pdf](#)

**How did you find out about Science Corps?**

University email list

**Any other comments/questions?**

Preferred start date: Some time between August - October 2022.

Preferred location: Aavishkaar Palampur (India) and CVIF Philippines

[Science Corps](#)